

EU accuses Microsoft

The European Union has formally accused Microsoft of failing to provide alternate browser choices to customers, despite a previous order



Samsung Ativ Smart PC

Samsung unveiled the latest models of its Ativ computers' range of Smart PCs, that run on the Windows 8 platform

Bazaar

AMD A10-5800K

The Trinity APU that is much better than discrete entry level GPUs



Features 70
Performance..... 75
Build Quality NA
Value for money..... 70

Specifications

Base Clock: 3.8 GHz; Turbo Clock: 4.2 GHz; L2 cache: 4 MB; Integrated Graphics: Radeon HD 7660D; GPU clock: 800 MHz; Radeon Cores: 384

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AMD had us all impressed with the graphics performance of their Fusion series Llano APU – AMD A8-3850 last year. Carrying that tradition forward, AMD's latest APU – the A10-5800K, gives even better graphics performance. The quad-core A10-5800K is the flagship APU codenamed Trinity, has a base clock of 3.8 GHz which can scale up to 4.2 GHz on Turbo. It houses the 384-core Radeon HD 7660D GPU clocked at 800 MHz. This is quite an upgrade from the HD 6550D that was seen on the A8-3850.

We tested the APU on Gigabyte GA-F2A85X-UP4 board and 8 GB RAM @ 1333MHz. When it came to processor prowess, the A10-5800K gave 13,203 on Cinebench R10, a 9 per cent increase over the A8-3850. The score is still lower than the Intel Core i7-2600K. iTunes encoding



Price
₹7,000

was 15 secs faster on the A10-5800K than the A8 3850. But the real strength of this APU lies in the gaming performance. *Resident Evil 5* (1680x1050,

medium, DX10) gave 52 fps; *STALKER: COP* (1680x1050, medium, DX11) gave a decent 32.4 fps and *DIRT 3* (1680x1050, med) gave 42.1 fps. These readings were much better than HD 4000 on the Intel Core i7-3770K, being over 12 fps in *Resident Evil 5* and *Dirt 3*. When we increased the memory speed to 1866MHz, we got a boost of 10 fps on each game on the A10-5800K.

If you are looking for a GPU-independent system, this is the processor for you. It offers the best gaming performance that we have seen on any processor, but is not so great at computing tasks. It is priced at USD 125 which will come around ₹7,000 which is a decent price.

Nimish Sawant

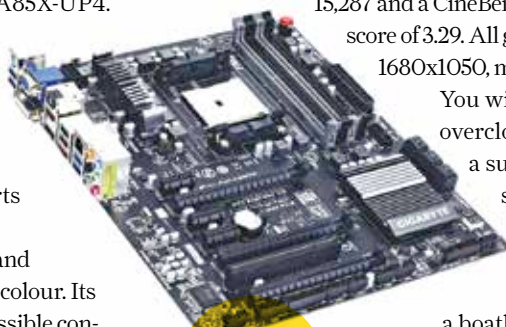
Gigabyte GA F2A85X-UP4

Feature-packed board for the latest Trinity APUs

AMD unveiled their Trinity APU platform for desktop and along with it a new socket – FM2. Gigabyte sent us their FM2 socket board – the GA F2A85X-UP4.

As you will notice from the nomenclature, it has a new A85X chipset. It offers some improvements over the A75 chipset in the form of two extra 6 Gbps ports and AMD Crossfire mode.

The board is well laid out and looks lovely in its matte black colour. Its back panel I/O port has all possible connectivity ports you can think of, including four display ports, four USB 3.0 ports and so on. The heatsink around the VRMs does not look very bulky, whereas the one of the Fusion control hub chipset is quite respectable with decent number of fins. It has a POST error code LEDs and a dedicated power and CMOS reset button.



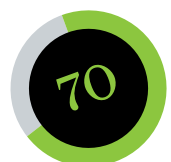
Price
₹11,750

We tested an AMD A10-5800K APU along with 8 GB Kingston HyperX RAM using integrated HD 7660D graphics. We got a PC Mark Vantage score of 15,287 and a CineBench R11.5 multi-core rendering score of 3.29. All games score over 30 fps at 1680x1050, medium settings.

You will be much better off overclocking via the BIOS. We got a sufficient boost in gaming scores when we overclocked the memory to 2,133MHz. For a mid-range motherboard, it offers a boatload of features which we like. Overclocking was not as smooth as we expected, but then the APU that the UP4 will hold is more geared towards gaming.

As was expected from the number of features offered, the price of this board is definitely on the higher side considering the APU costs much less.

Nimish Sawant



Features 75
Overclocking..... 65
Build Quality 80
Value for money..... 60

Specifications

Chipset: AMD A85X; SATA 6 Gbps ports: 6; USB 3.0 ports: 4; DIMM slots: 4; Display ports: 1xHDMI, 1xD-Sub, 1xDVI-D, 1xDisplayPort; Audio: Realtek ALC892 codec; DualBIOS: Yes

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